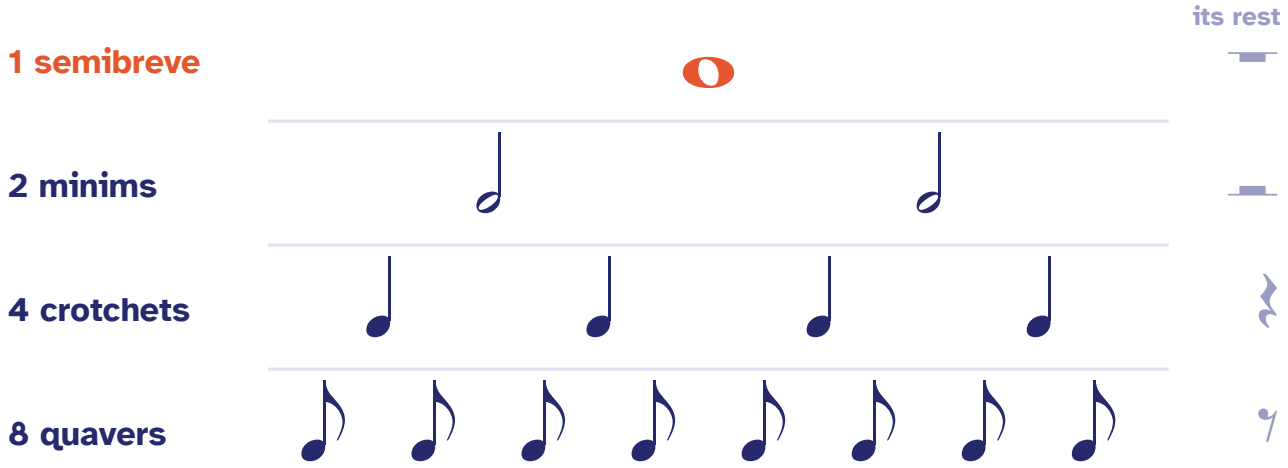PART II · TIME · 2

# Notes and rests

You can see how long a note lasts from its shape: each note is **half** the one above it. And every note has a twin **rest**, a silence you count just as carefully.

**THE SECRET**

**Each note is half the one above it, and every note has a rest twin.**

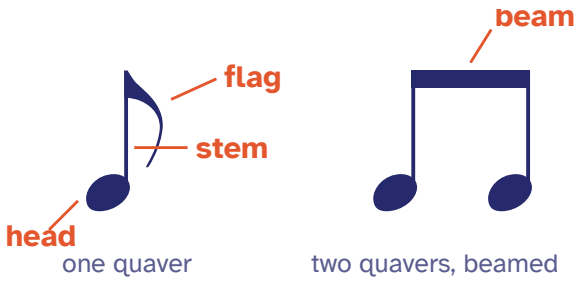



*Each note splits into two of the next*

**Counting quavers:** say the beat's number, then "&" halfway to the next beat: "1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &".

## Head, stem, flag

The **head** sits on a line or in a space. Every note but the semibreve has a **stem**. A **flag** halves the note; quavers side by side share a **beam** instead.




one quaver — two quavers, beamed

## Which way does the stem go?




**below: stem up, on the right** — **on or above: stem down, on the left**

The stem never changes the note's length: it only keeps the page tidy.

## Every note has a twin rest




| semibreve | minim | crotchet | quaver | semiquaver |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| note and rest: 4 beats | note and rest: 2 beats | note and rest: 1 beat | note and rest: ½ beat | note and rest: ¼ beat |

PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

### THE SEMIBREVE REST'S SPECIAL POWER

Most rests last a fixed number of beats. The **semibreve rest** can also mean **a whole bar of silence** in any time signature: 4 beats in 4/4, but 3 in 3/4 and 2 in 2/4. It is then centred in the bar. No other rest can do this.



silent: 1 2 3



silent: 1 2

Same length, no sound. The two big rests look alike: the **semibreve rest hangs** from line 4, heavy as a coat on a hook; the **minim rest sits** on line 3, like a hat.

### Why whole, half and quarter?

Think of each beat as a pizza. A bar of 4/4 is four pizzas. The note that fills a whole bar of 4/4 is the **whole note**; the others are a half, a quarter, an eighth and a sixteenth of it. Two quavers beamed together fill one pizza. A rest is the same share left empty: shaded with lines.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **semibreve** | whole note | 4 pizzas · 4 beats | |
| semibreve rest | silence | 4 beats, or a whole bar | |
| **minim** | half note | 2 pizzas · 2 beats | |
| minim rest | silence | 2 empty pizzas · 2 beats | |
| **crotchet** | quarter note | 1 pizza · 1 beat | |
| crotchet rest | silence | 1 empty pizza · 1 beat | |
| **quaver** | eighth note | half a pizza · ½ beat | |
| quaver rest | silence | half an empty pizza · ½ beat | |
| **semiquaver** | sixteenth note | a quarter of a pizza · ¼ beat | |
| semiquaver rest | silence | a quarter of an empty pizza · ¼ beat | |

EXAMPLE 1

**How long is each sound, and each silence?**



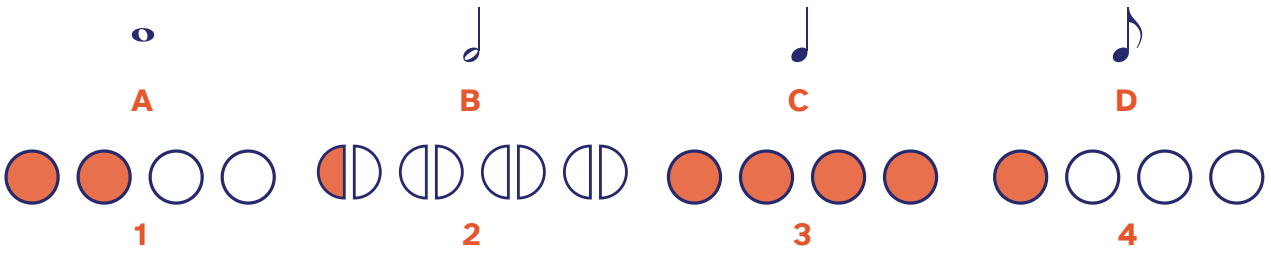
1. **Name each shape** in the bar.
2. **How many beats** does each one last?
3. **Add them up,** rests included. What is the total?

Minim 2, crotchet 1, crotchet rest 1: every bar adds up to **4 beats**, silences included.

PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

GAME

## Pizza match




Match each note (A to D) with its pizzas (1 to 4). One pizza is one beat.

Answer: A 3, B 1, C 4, D 2.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS

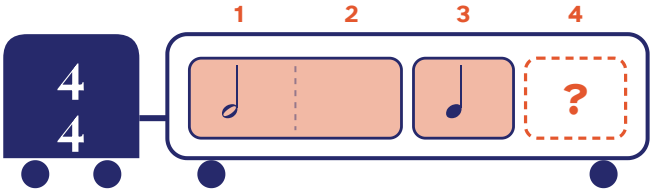


**Clap once and hold for 2: a minim.**

Now clap four crotchets (1 2 3 4), then one semibreve (clap, and hold all four beats). Say the counts out loud.

EXAMPLE 2

**Fill a bar of 4/4: what goes in the last seat?**
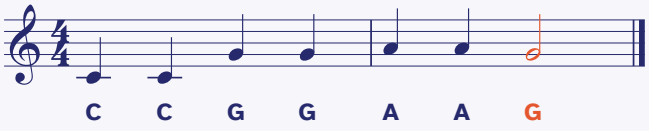



1. **How many seats** does the minim take?
2. **And the crotchet?**
3. **How many seats are left** for a silence, and which rest fills one seat?

2 + 1 = 3, one seat left: a **crotchet rest**. The bar is full.

YOU KNOW THIS

## Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star




Six **crotchets**, then a **minim** at the end of the line: one beat, one beat … and two beats to breathe.

SEE ALSO

Pulse and the bar p. 50 · How long is a note? p. 56

PRACTISE IT

Workbook Level 0 · Note values · Online: Library › Notes